Project Overview

Project Objective

1. Project Objective

The objective of this project is to implement an automated workflow using Flow Designer to facilitate the procurement and configuration of standard laptops. By integrating automation into the process, the project aims to achieve the four objectives described below.

2. Objectives in Detail

Objective 1: Create a seamless experience for users

Users requesting standard laptops should receive them ready to use without avoidable waiting. By ensuring the configuration task is created and assigned as soon as the request is approved, timely configuration becomes part of the standard process.

Objective 2: Reduce manual intervention and potential errors

Manual task creation depends on people remembering to act. The flow generates the Catalog Task automatically with a consistent short description and assignment group, which removes these manual steps and the errors that come with them.

Objective 3: Improve resource utilisation within the IT department

Tasks are routed directly to the Hardware group, so the team receives its work without intermediaries. IT procurement staff are freed from follow-up activity and can focus on other work.

Objective 4: Enhance overall efficiency and productivity

Automating a repeated step shortens the overall procurement cycle for standard laptops and makes the process consistent, which improves productivity across IT procurement operations.

3. Expected Outcomes

- An active flow, **Standard Laptop task**, that creates a Catalog Task for each Standard Laptop request.
- The flow attached to the Standard Laptop catalog item.
- Catalog Tasks assigned automatically to the Hardware group.
- A verified end-to-end process from ordering and approval to task generation.

4. Alignment with Project Milestones

Objective	How it is achieved	Milestone
1. Seamless user experience	Task is generated as soon as the request is approved.	Milestones 1 and 3

Objective	How it is achieved	Milestone
2. Less manual intervention	The flow creates and populates the Catalog Task automatically.	Milestone 1
3. Better resource utilisation	Task is assigned directly to the Hardware group.	Milestones 1 and 2
4. Higher efficiency	The flow runs every time the catalog item is ordered.	Milestones 2 and 3

5. Success Criteria

- Ordering the Standard Laptop and approving the request results in a Catalog Task without manual action.
- The task shows the correct short description and the Hardware assignment group.
- No manual step is needed between approval and task creation.

6. How Success Will Be Checked

Objective	What to check
1. Seamless user experience	The task is created as soon as the request is approved.
2. Less manual intervention	No one has to create or edit the task by hand.
3. Better resource utilisation	The task appears in the Hardware group's assignment.
4. Higher efficiency	Repeated orders produce the same result every time.

7. Benefits to the Organisation

- Shorter time from approval to a configured laptop.
- Lower dependence on individual follow-up.
- A repeatable process that can be extended to other catalog items in future.
- Better service quality for users and a lighter administrative load for IT.

8. Constraints and Assumptions

- The solution is built using ServiceNow Flow Designer.
- The Standard Laptop catalog item and the Hardware assignment group are available.
- The scope is limited to standard laptop orders.

9. Deliverables

- The Standard Laptop task flow, created and activated in Flow Designer.
- The Standard Laptop catalog item configured to use the flow.

- A tested order showing the generated Catalog Task with the Hardware assignment group.
- Documentation with screenshots for each milestone.

10. Future Enhancements

- Email notifications to the Hardware team and the requester when the task is created.
- SLA tracking to measure the time taken to configure laptops.
- Extending the same approach to other standard hardware and software items.

11. Conclusion

Together, these objectives describe a process in which approved standard laptop requests move to configuration automatically and without delay. The three project milestones implement this by building the flow, attaching it to the catalog item and verifying the result through a test order.